The Future is Radiant

Asian Paints' ColourNext unveils the design trends shaping your home in 2026

BUREAU REPORT

In an era saturated by digital noise, our homes are evolving from mere functional spaces into profound sanctuaries of quiet, intentional living. The good news is that Asian Paints has just released ColourNext 2026, its 23rd annual forecast, and the vibe for the future is clear: it's time to slow down, get tactile and find magic in the "real" world. It's a deep dive into how science labs and digital fatigue are reshaping our living rooms. ColourNext is South Asia's premier design crystal ball, blending insights from architects, sociologists and artists. This year, the report traces how shifts emerging across science labs, digital culture and everyday life translate into new design languages, moving us away from mere consumption and toward deep, meaningful connection.

The Star of the Show

At the very heart of this cultural landscape sits the Colour of the Year 2026, Moonlit Silk (Shade Code 7809). This warm, luminous neutral reflects a collective longing for slowness and emotional grounding in an overstimulated world. Radiant yet restrained, it evokes the softness of worn pages and the comfort of everyday rituals, offering a quiet presence without the need for performance. It is the tone of unperformed moments—the soft light of home at dusk or laughter that doesn't require an audience—acting as a calming anchor for contemporary spaces that seek warmth, quiet confidence, and an enduring relevance that transcends fleeting trends.

Four Directions for a New Era

The forecast identifies four interconnected design directions. We begin with IRL, a conscious rebellion against the curated paralysis of algorithms; it's an invitation to step into the tactile, unpredictable world with intention. Next is Solarpunk that offers a vision of "stubborn optimism," where technology and nature come together to create regenerative, life-affirming spaces. Together, these directions suggest that the future of design isn't about escaping reality,





Pastoral theme supported by candle stands by Kaash at Nilaya Anthology and bench from Gulmohar Lane